Assignment: Animatic Creation with Blender VSE

Objective

Produce a polished animatic for your short film using Blender's Video Sequence Editor. The animatic should demonstrate clear storyboard sequencing, visually driven pacing, narrative clarity, and professional presentation based solely on your storyboard panels.

Instructions

1. **Storyboard Preparation**
- Use your full set of storyboard panels from your short film project.
- Label and number panels visually to ensure sequence clarity and facilitate feedback.
2. **Import and Arrange in Blender VSE**
- Import all panels into Blender's Video Sequence Editor.
- Arrange panels in a logical, narrative order with no gaps or confusion.
3. **Timing, Pacing, and Visual Clarity**
- Assign an appropriate duration for each panel to emphasize key story beats.
- Reference guideline:
    - **Dialogue/acting:** 3–6 seconds per panel
    - **Action:** 1–2 seconds
    - **Establishing:** 3–5 seconds
    - **Reaction:** 2–4 seconds
    - **Quick transitions:** 1–2 seconds
- Ensure every panel is visually clear, readable, and maintains a consistent aspect ratio and resolution throughout the animatic.
4. **Presentation Elements**
- Use up to three simple transitions (dissolves, fades) if needed for clarity only—not as style.
- Include a title card at the start and an end card at the close for professional presentation.
5. **Review and Revise**
- Play back your animatic multiple times, revising panel order and durations to achieve the best narrative rhythm.
- Correct any visual, pacing, or sequencing issues.
6. **Export and Submission**

- Export the animatic as a single MP4 file.
- Verify the export plays smoothly with no broken frames or technical errors.
- Submit the MP4 by the specified assignment deadline.

Recommended time commitment: 10–15 hours